

Nobuyoshi Shimmen

Engineer

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198-0088 Tokyo, Ome
Urajukucho 667-4

070-4087-4039
nobuyoshi.shimmen@gmail.com

About Me

Full-stack engineer and PdM with 10+ years of experience building products from zero in startups. I take ownership across the entire product lifecycle — from customer discovery and planning to engineering and support — while keeping business impact as the primary compass. Over the past year I've leaned heavily on LLMs for code generation and Dev/Ops automation, shipping and operating a product as the sole engineer. I thrive at the intersection of business and engineering, and I've seen firsthand why good initial design matters when a product scales.

Experience

PLAID, Inc. /PdM/Engineer

DEC 2025 - PRESENT, TOKYO

- Transitioned to PLAID, Inc. following the acquisition, continuing to own the same advertising reporting product as PdM and Engineer.
- Led a paid PoC for same-day ad data acquisition with a key client and PMM, validating the upgrade from T-1 to same-day retrieval. Confirmed for production rollout; evaluated by PMM as a future differentiator and currently being proposed to additional clients.
(BigQuery, Looker Studio)
- Organized 4 weekly claude.ai workshops for 4-5 non-engineer ad operations staff, providing hands-on support for automating recurring tasks such as weekly report creation.
- Built a BigQuery data mart and Looker Studio dashboards for a major retail client to address rising query costs, reducing BQ scan volume by 22.8%.
(BigQuery, Looker Studio)

agito, Inc. /PdM/Tech Lead

SEPT 2018 - NOV 2025, TOKYO

2024/10 - 2025/11

- Owned the full lifecycle of a new AI-powered advertising product as sole engineer and PdM — from client discovery (in partnership with sales) and planning through development, release, and support. Shipped a beta of an integrated platform featuring three tools:
(TypeScript, Node.js, Next.js, Cloud Run, PubSub, Memorystore, BigQuery, Vertex AI, Gemini API, OpenAI API)
 - Campaign Search (Semantic): Automated the manual process of finding similar past campaigns using BigQuery × Vertex AI vector search. Built from scratch — no prior search capability existed.
 - Campaign Simulation: Predicted performance for new campaigns based on historical data from similar campaigns, enabling data-driven decisions in sales and planning.
 - Creative Generation: Built a system to auto-generate ad banner images and copy from landing page URLs. Pivoted to generating optimized prompts for image generation AI after the release of gpt-image-1.

2023/01 – 2024/09 · PdM

- As Tech Lead, led the full rollout of serverless migration across ~40 ad platforms, extending an architecture I had originally designed. Implemented a PubSub-triggered pipeline that starts data retrieval immediately upon account registration, enabling same-day data availability — where competitors required clients to wait until the following day.
(Go, PubSub, Cloud Run, BigQuery)
- As PdM, defined and managed the product roadmap in collaboration with the CEO and PMM, keeping business strategy and development plans aligned.
(Team: 8–10 engineers, 5–6 CS)
- Reduced report setup time from ~30 minutes to one click by building a Looker Studio Linking API integration, accelerating client time-to-value. Later expanded the same mechanism into a native feature in the core application.
(Looker Studio Linking API)
- Joined onboarding sessions for enterprise clients as the technical representative, briefing their engineering teams on ad data schemas, ingestion schedules, and data mart usage.
- Shipped beta integrations for GA4, AppsFlyer, and Adjust using Google Apps Script to validate market demand with minimal engineering investment. Confirmed partial demand; decided against full integration given the projected ROI. The beta serves as a sales asset, giving the team a credible "we support these platforms" talking point in deals.
(Google Apps Script, BigQuery)

2018/09 - 2022/12 — Joined the PLAID Group in 2022/10

- As a founding engineer, developed the advertising reporting platform from the ground up alongside the CTO.
- Scaled connected ad accounts from 3,000 to 20,000 and grew daily report volume to approx. 200,000/day by resolving scalability bottlenecks through

BigQuery partition design and async processing optimization.

- Migrated the existing GAE monolith to a serverless Cloud Run + PubSub async architecture, improving scalability and reducing operational overhead. (Go, PubSub, Cloud Run, Datastore, Memorystore, Cloud Scheduler, BigQuery)
- Built a data mart generator to link ad data with client budget and KPI data. (Go, PubSub, Cloud Run, Datastore, BigQuery)
- Developed full-stack web applications including a SQL generator for BI tools and an Excel report generator. (JavaScript, Vue.js (Vuetify), PHP (Laravel), GCE)

ubun,inc. / Freelance Engineer

FEB 2021 - APR 2022, TOKYO

- Developed an application targeted for Amazon sellers.
- Responsible for front-end, back-end, and batch processing as a full stack developer.

TVISION Insights Inc. / Freelance Engineer

JUN 2018 - AUG 2018, TOKYO

- Created an internal web application.
- Resourcefully and confidently managed time and projects independently.

Techloco, Inc. / Engineer

OCT 2015 - JUL 2018, TOKYO

- Collaborated in developing an all-in-one marketing tool.
- Proposed and developed an application that allows users to review, comment on website designs on their browsers.

Soldout, Inc. / Marketing Division

APR 2014 - SEP 2015, TOKYO

- Developed Google Apps Scripts, using Salesforce API, and Hubspot API to improve business workflow.

Education

Aoyama University / Bachelor of Business Administration, BBA

APR 2010 - MAR 2014, TOKYO

The University of Vermont / Concentration in Business

AUG 2012 - MAY 2013, BURLINGTON, VERMONT, USA

- 9 month long exchange program through International Partnership & Collaboration

Skills & Interests

Computer Languages

Proficient Level: Go, TypeScript/JavaScript, PHP, HTML/CSS, SQL

Intermediate Level: Node.js

Hobby: Dart, Python, Swift

Infrastructures

GCP

Compute: Cloud Run, GAE, GCE

Data: BigQuery, Cloud SQL, Datastore, Memorystore, Cloud Storage

Messaging: PubSub, Cloud Scheduler

AI/ML: Vertex AI (Vector Search)

Observability: Cloud Monitoring, Cloud Logging, Cloud Build

Other: Firebase

AWS: EC2, S3

CI/CD & Tools: GitHub Actions, Circle CI, Docker, Git

Generative AI: claude.ai, Claude Code, OpenAI API, Gemini API, Vertex AI (Vector Search), LLM Prompt Engineering

Languages

Native Level: Japanese

Business Level: English (TOEIC score 960)

Interests and Hobbies

- Developing entrepreneurial side projects
- Running an independent side service
- Spending time with family
- Studying fitness and working out

Certificates

Udacity/Machine Learning Engineer Nanodegree

2016-2017

Udacity/iOS Engineer Nanodegree

2015

Links

Blog

<https://www.tumblr.com/blog/nobuyoshi-shimmen>

GitHub

<https://github.com/Generalbelly>

LinkedIn

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/nobuyoshi-shimmen-9a8b1a94/>
